Creamy Garlic Chicken Skillet

The Tuesday answer. Thighs, a heavy skillet, more garlic than seems reasonable, and a sauce that comes together while the rice finishes. Jimmy eats the chicken and leaves the spinach; Gracie does the reverse. Between them, a clean pan.

Provenance · Tyler · the household standard since 2024

Main | Chicken | Weeknight | Skillet | Any season

Family table | Kid-approved

Active 25 min | Total 40 min | Serves 4

✓ **Proven** · cooked 11 times · last 14 Oct

INGREDIENTS

For the chicken

1½ lb	boneless, skinless chicken thighs
1 tsp	kosher salt
½ tsp	black pepper
1 tsp	smoked paprika
2 tbsp	olive oil

For the sauce

3 tbsp	butter
8 cloves	garlic, sliced thin
1 cup	chicken stock
¾ cup	heavy cream
½ cup	Parmesan, grated
1 tsp	Dijon mustard

To finish

3 cups	baby spinach
½	lemon, juiced
a handful	parsley, chopped
	rice or crusty bread, to serve

METHOD

1 Pat the thighs dry and season with the salt, pepper, and paprika. Heat the oil in a 12-inch skillet over medium-high until it shimmers.

2 Sear the thighs five minutes a side without moving them, until deeply browned. Move to a plate; they will not be cooked through, and that is fine.

3 Drop the heat to medium. Add the butter, then the garlic, and stir for ninety seconds, until fragrant and just turning gold. Do not let it

brown.

4 Pour in the stock and scrape up the fond. Simmer three minutes to reduce by about a third.

5 Stir in the cream, Parmesan, and Dijon. Return the chicken and any juices; simmer eight to ten minutes, until the sauce coats a spoon and the thighs read 165°.

6 Fold in the spinach until it wilts, then the lemon. Taste for salt. Parsley over the top; serve over rice with plenty of the pan sauce.

Changed in v4

Cream down from 1 cup to ¾, and the Dijon is new. The sauce no longer breaks on reheating.

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v4 · Tyler · written Nov 2025 · entered Oct 2026 · History

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